his rule of close to 200 years. Ironically, indigenous OET systems are scrutinised more than the coloniser's OET thanks to this coloniality.

It is precisely for this reason that the European coloniser's track record in the rest of the world, which screams religious *and hence* racial supremacism, ought to be understood better even if one's interest is limited to Bharat. How else can one hope to make sense of a global phenomenon? Unfortunately, barring the work of a handful of scholars, this aspect has not received the kind of rigorous and serious scrutiny in Bharat that it should have. The result being that the deep and innate strength of Bharat's consciousness—which has resisted the tsunami of coloniality with a greater degree of success than most other indigenous societies whose cultures, civilisations, and consciousness were nearly wiped out—is never recognised and acknowledged. This is not to deny that European coloniality did indeed make deep inroads even in Bharat, which is evident from the latter's present tendency to secularise facts. This tendency has put to sleep a society that is in dire need of awareness of its own strength and consciousness to deal with the continued presence of coloniality of more than one kind.

To cut a long story short, it is my considered position that in the absence of any hard evidence to the contrary, the most plausible and reasonable inference that may be drawn based on the global experience with European coloniality is that Bharat too was approached with the same colonial lens, and one need not even delve into Bharat-specific literature to make this point. That said, Bharat-specific literature needs to be delved into to understand the local/contextual manifestations of coloniality and its continuing effects. The object of this exercise is to prove the core premise of decolonial thought, which distinguishes it from postcolonial critique, that is, that coloniality did not cease to exist with the decolonisation of Bharat but has successfully continued in 'independent' Bharat, having been secularised, modernised and internalised—either due to complete ignorance or deliberate negation of history.

The internalisation of European coloniality in Bharat is evident from the constant refrain of its elites that had it not been for the British—who had apparently stitched together a single country out of disparate entities with nothing in common—Bharat would not have been a single political unit or a 'nation'; and that Bharat would have lacked infrastructure, such as trains, post, telegraph and the like, but for 'investment' by the coloniser in Bharat.